8 Model

8.1 Introduction

In Laravel, a model is a central part of the MVC (Model-View-Controller) architecture. It represents the application's data structure and is used to interact with the database.

8.2 Understanding Models in Laravel

- Models are typically linked to a table in the database.
- Laravel uses Eloquent ORM to handle database operations with models.

Example:

```
php artisan make:model Product
```

This command creates a `Product` model in `app/Models/Product.php`.

Code Example:

```
namespace App\Models;

use Illuminate\Database\Eloquent\Model;

class Product extends Model
{
    protected $fillable = ['name', 'price', 'stock'];
}
```

8.3 Entities and POCO (Plain Old Class Object)

While Laravel doesn't enforce strict entity definitions like in DDD (Domain-Driven Design), it's useful to treat models as entities representing business logic.

POCO in Laravel can be understood as simple PHP classes without Laravel-specific behavior.

Example: